SWIM

Week 09 Swim

Week 9 of 52 | Mon 30 Nov 2026 to Sun 06 Dec 2026 | Month 2: Recovery week and checkpoint

The idea this month: short fast lengths with full rest, stroke count as the honesty check, fins as a teaching tool. Endurance volume comes back once the fast stroke is the default. 25 m pool. Every swim is 700-1,100 m and 22-35 minutes.

Monday, 30 Nov Swim 1 - Recovery week, builds only (22 min)

Focus: Light week. No fast set, just the feeling.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Fingertip drag / 25 FS) r20
Main	4 x Build 50 r30 with fins. Easy, and enjoy the speed at the end of each.
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 700 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no.

Thursday, 03 Dec Swim 2 - Checkpoint 200 m (28 min)

Focus: The number for the Month 2 reflection. Pace per 100 and strokes per 25 together, not pace alone.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Catch-up / 25 FS) r20
Checkpoint	200 m time trial from a push, no fins, even pace. Record the time and the stroke count per 25 on the sheet. Reference from 30 Oct: 1:50 per 100 average, best 50 at 1:34 pace, 13 strokes per 25. Only if the shoulder has been 0-1/10 for the last two weeks; otherwise swim 4 x 50 easy instead and test in Week 10.
Easy	4 x 50 FS r20
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 900 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no. No pool today? 30-40 min elliptical at a conversational effort is the fallback, not a replacement to prefer.

Drill cue cards for this week

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Fingertip drag	Swim normally but during the recovery let the fingertips trail along the surface, elbow high and pointing to the ceiling. Purpose: relaxed, high-elbow recovery and shoulder rotation.
Build 50	Start the 50 easy and finish it fast, without letting the stroke shorten. Purpose: learning to raise speed by pressing harder on the water, not by spinning the arms.
Catch-up	Both arms start extended. One arm pulls and recovers while the other waits out front; the recovering hand touches the waiting hand before the next stroke starts. Purpose: long stroke, front-quadrant timing, patience in the glide.
Stroke count	Count strokes per 25 m (one arm = one stroke). Write down your normal count, then try to hold pace with one fewer. Purpose: efficiency and distance per stroke.

Shoulder and stroke log (0 = no pain, 10 = worst pain)

Session	Shoulder during	Next morning	Strokes per 25, fast	Best 25 or 50 time	Notes
Monday					
Thursday					